THE MESSY HANDS COOKING MODE

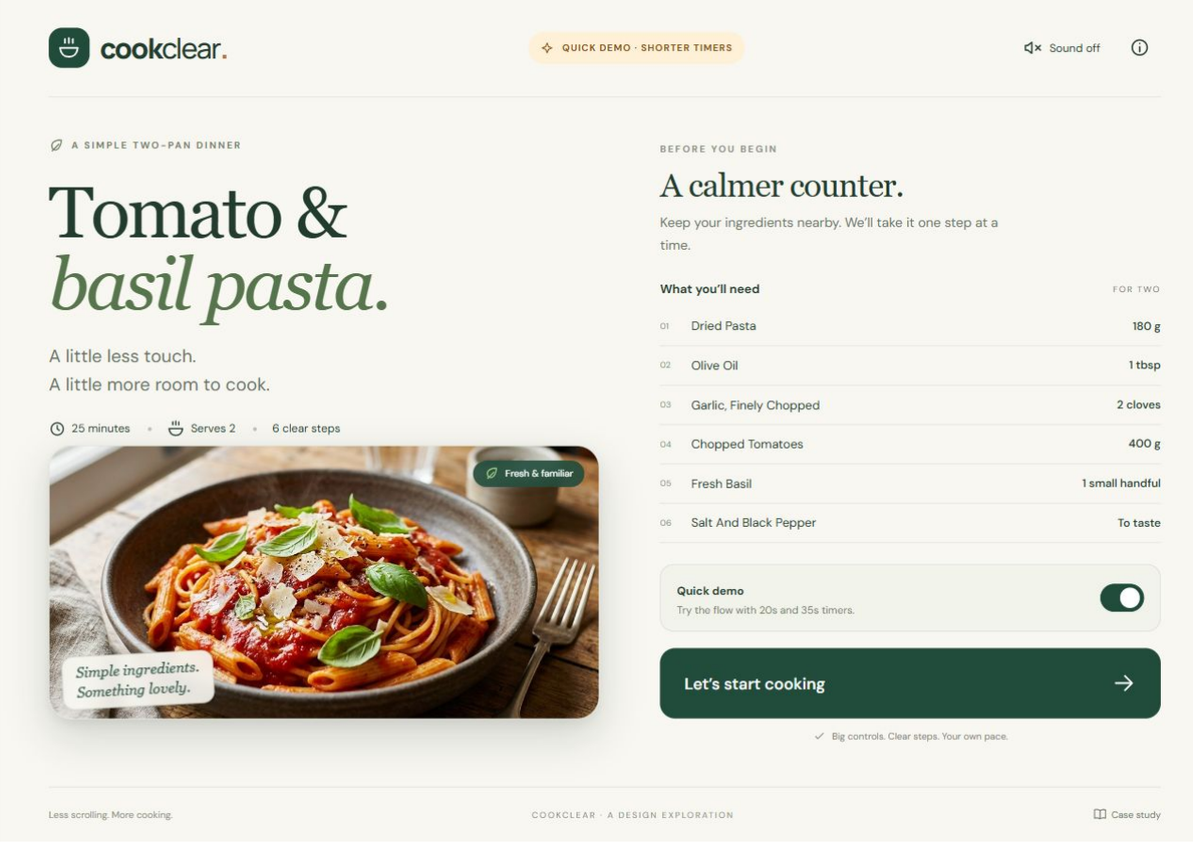
Less touching. More cooking.

CookClear

A focused tablet recipe interface for occupied hands and parallel cooking tasks.

- 3-5 feet viewing
- Generous cooking controls
- Two persistent named timers

Open the working prototype



Actual browser prototype

SECONDARY RESEARCH + DESIGN + IMPLEMENTATION

The recipe should stay with the cook.

A countertop tablet. Occupied hands. Several tasks cooking at once.

The problem

A dense recipe page asks the cook to read, scroll, find quantities, and remember which timer belongs to which task.

DESIGN HYPOTHESIS

One dominant step, generous controls, and named timers can make cooking easier to follow.

Context comes from the assignment. No participant study is included.

01 **Coarse input needs generous targets.**

W3C recommends larger targets in relevant situations. Its 44px enhanced criterion is a baseline with exceptions, not an elbow standard.

W3C: Target Size (Enhanced)

02 **Release and recovery reduce mistakes.**

W3C describes up-event activation and undo. Native buttons and a visible Previous action inform CookClear's recovery path.

W3C: Pointer Cancellation

03 **Timers are established recipe functionality.**

Crouton and Paprika document cooking timers. The design opportunity here is clear task identity and continuity across steps.

Crouton documentation; Paprika linked on page 8

Three constraints. One focused surface.

Each interface decision traces to a requirement in the supplied brief.

01

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

View from 3-5 feet

A single dominant instruction

Keep the action and quantities together. Use short lines and a strong contrast hierarchy. Reduce competing content.

Physical distance readability is unvalidated.

02

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

Occupied or messy hands

Generous controls + recovery

Separate large actions. Keep Previous available. Use native buttons so activation follows a normal release interaction.

Elbow detection and comfort are device-dependent and unvalidated.

03

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

Several active timers

Task identity stays visible

Label Pasta and Sauce independently. Keep their states visible through step changes, expiry, and refresh.

Timer behavior is verified separately from physical usability.

Keep progress and cooking time separate.

Moving to another instruction changes the view. It never starts or resets a timer.

01 **Review recipe** → 02 **Start cooking** → 03 **Start Pasta** → 04 **Start Sauce** → 05 **Acknowledge** → 06 **Complete steps**

RECOVERY BRANCH

Previous returns to an earlier step while timers continue. Refresh restores saved progress and reconciles deadlines. A fresh session makes reset deliberate.

REVISION 01 / CONTROLS ABOVE THE FOLD

Early browser review placed Next below the fold at 1280x800. Landscape tablets now use a one-screen layout that scales type and controls with height. All six steps fit without page scrolling across seven landscape viewports. Compact layouts prioritize instructions and controls.

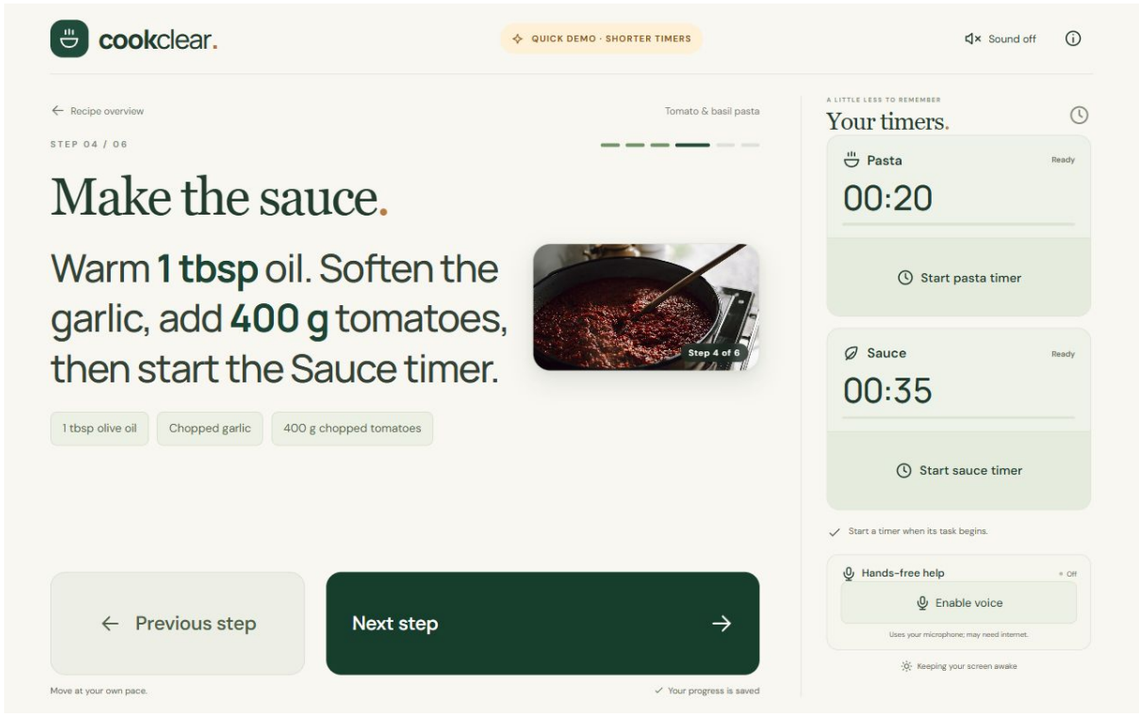
REVISION 02 / QUANTITIES STAY WHOLE

Number-unit pairs such as "400 g" need to stay together. Quantities in each instruction are bold and cannot break across lines, preserving the relationship between the number and its unit.

BOUNDARY One recipe; React + local storage; deadline-based timers; no accounts, backend, or search.

One step leads. Everything else supports.

The final browser view gives the current instruction visual priority.



Actual prototype screenshot. Landscape tablet composition; no physical reading claim.

01 Instruction first

A short action and its quantities occupy the main reading area.

02 Clear progress

The current step anchors the cook in the sequence.

03 Named timer rail

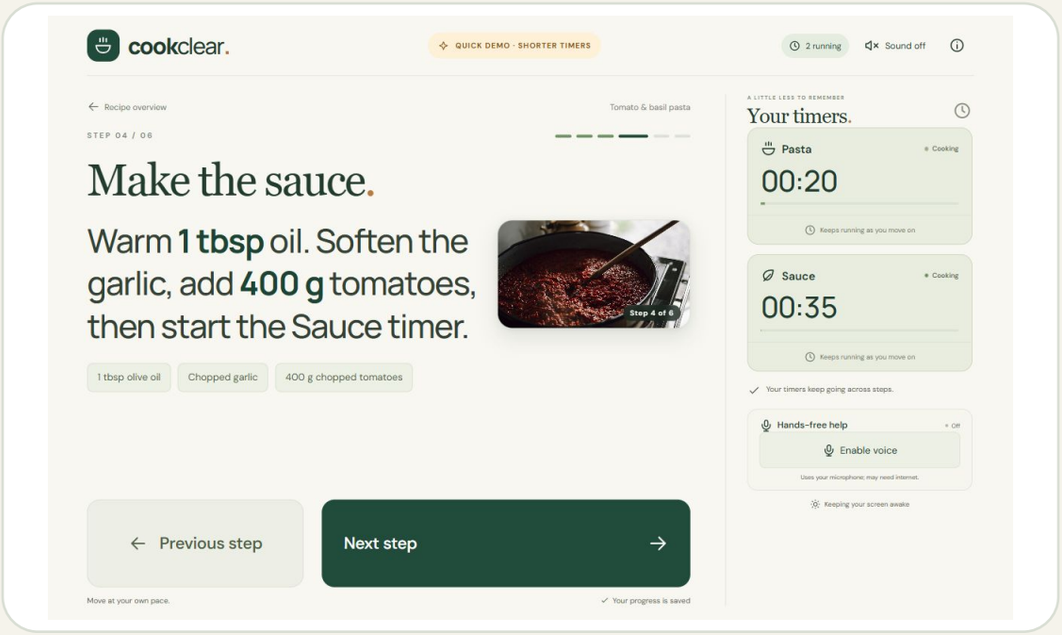
Task labels remain visible while the instruction changes.

04 Visible recovery

Previous stays available beside the primary action.

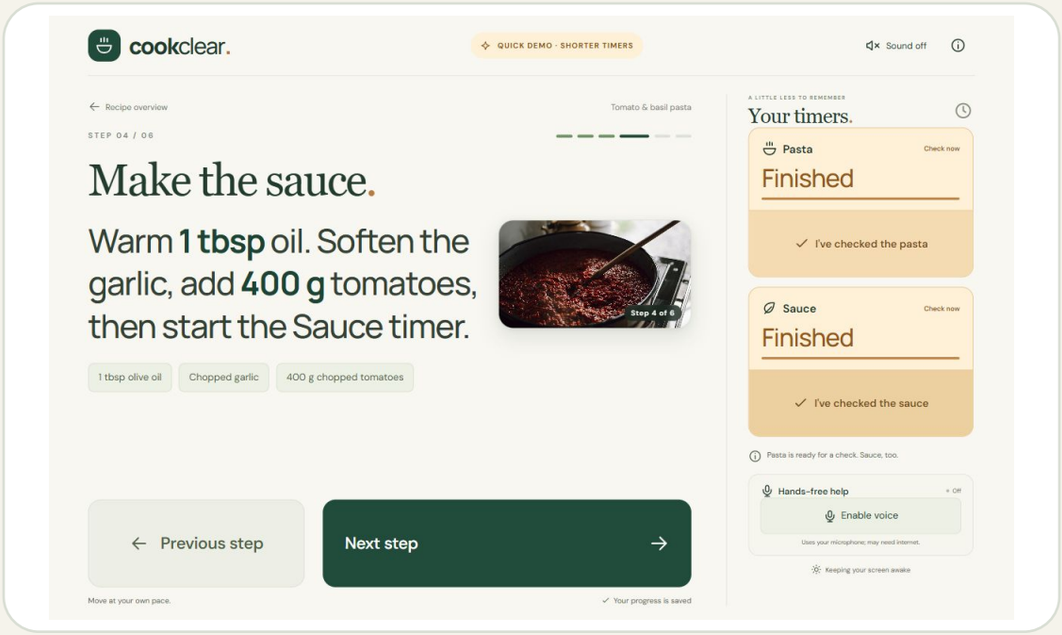
Time continues, even when attention shifts.

Ready > Running > Finished > Acknowledged. Screenshots show the labelled 20s / 35s timer demo.



TWO ACTIVE TIMERS

Each timer keeps its label and deadline through step changes. Remaining time = deadline - current clock. Normal recipe timers: 10m / 6m.



TASK-SPECIFIC EXPIRY

A finished task remains visible until acknowledged. Acknowledgement affects that task only; the other timer continues.

MDN documents background callback throttling. This demo verifies foreground visual expiry and restoration; it does not promise an audible alarm while the OS suspends the browser.

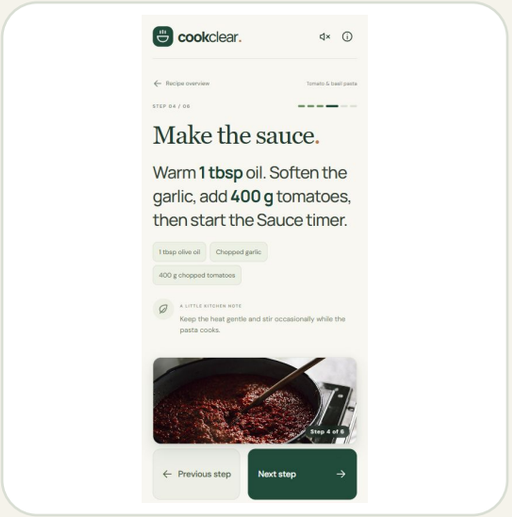
Verify the behavior. Label the evidence.

Software checks document implemented behavior. They do not substitute for a participant study.

CHECK	RESULT
Two timers keep independent deadlines	PASS
Repeated start cannot reset a timer	PASS
Expiry after a clock jump / late callback	PASS
Acknowledging one leaves the other running	PASS
Step bounds; Back keeps timers running	PASS
Reload restores deadlines; bad data recovers	PASS
Controls on screen, no scroll (7 landscape sizes)	PASS
Spoken voice on the target tablet	LIMITED

Production build passed (Vite 8.3.4). 10 of 10 Node logic tests passed.

Browser checks: Back and refresh preserve progress; acknowledging Pasta leaves Sauce running. All six steps fit seven landscape sizes. Portrait and phone have no horizontal overflow.



RESPONSIVE PHONE FALLBACK

EVIDENCE LIMIT

No participant study is included. Reading at 3-5 feet, elbow usability, and human task performance remain unvalidated.

Explore the cooking flow.

Open the real prototype and follow the clearly labelled short-timer demo.

WORKING BROWSER PROTOTYPE

Open CookClear

https://cookclear-kitchen.happylamp8.chatgpt.site

Review the recipe, enter the demo, start both named timers, advance and return, acknowledge a finished task, then refresh.

Delivered scope

One complete recipe; focused steps; generous controls; two timers; expiry; recovery; local restoration; responsive layout.

Future product directions

Adjustable text, additional recipes, and device-specific voice and notification support. Participant testing is outside this submission scope.

PRIMARY SOURCES

Supplied Nielsen assignment: the Messy Hands Cooking Mode. Public source links below informed the design and timer implementation.

W3C

Target Size (Enhanced)

W3C

Pointer Cancellation

CROUTON

Official product documentation

PAPRIKA

Official iOS user guide

MDN

Page Visibility API

Documentation review, not a hands-on competitor evaluation. Sources reviewed 10 October 2026.